

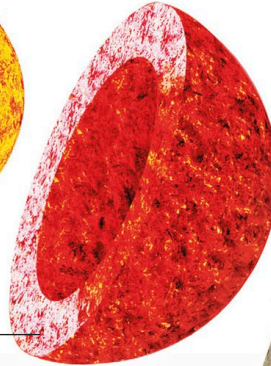
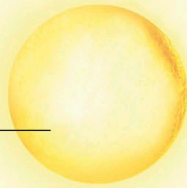
THE MOON



The inner core is a solid ball of pure iron only 240 km (150 miles) across

The outer core is a molten layer, consisting mainly of liquid iron

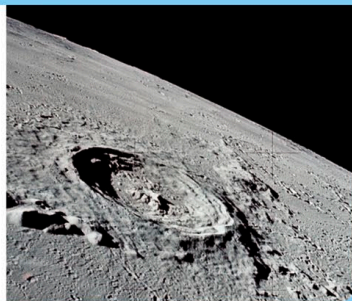
The lower mantle is a layer of partly molten rock, wrapped around the core



About a quarter the size of Earth, the Moon is its companion in space. Some astronomers refer to the Earth-Moon system as a “double planet”. The Moon is airless, rugged, and covered in craters and jagged mountains. Because it is so close to Earth, the Moon’s gravity causes tides in our seas.

LUNAR CRATERS

The Eratosthenes Crater is one of hundreds of craters that dot the Moon. They range in size from tiny pits to mountain-ringed dishes many hundreds of kilometres across. The Moon’s surface has hardly changed in billions of years.



The outer mantle is made of iron-rich rock